

CHICAGO BOOTH

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT CHICAGO BOOTH

When a business school ranks #1 in The Economist and Forbes, and #4 in the FT, many hundreds of MBA hopefuls will apply to the school in the hope of securing their place in one of the world's best business schools. But Chicago Booth is not for everybody. An integral part of a university that is very clearly focused on research, including the free market theory developed by the famous "Chicago School," Booth thrives on a culture of inquiry and innovation. The Admissions Committee is looking for individuals who like to challenge conventional wisdom and thrive in situations where they take the lead in solving problems.

The MBA program sets itself apart by having a total flexibility in its curriculum. The school assumes that a graduate student knows what he or she is looking for in an MBA and enables students to specialize in the areas that will help them pursue their future business life. This philosophy is a driving force of Chicago as a whole, and extends to the faculty, who are left to choose their pedagogical methodology. Chicago Booth is for students who know where they are going, are ready to go a step further in their chosen discipline, and want to be challenged with the theories and ideas of tomorrow.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Finance, Economics, Accounting, Entrepreneurship, Organizational
Behavior, Strategy

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	4	5	4	4	*
Financial Times	9	6	7	10	3
Forbes	7	-	1	-	-
The Economist	2	1	1	-	*
US News	3	1	3	3	3

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	4909	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	621	Avg GMAT	724
Admissions selectivity	27.6%	Avg GPA	3.6
Yield	45.83%	% International	30%
Total Tuition	US\$146,880	% Women	38%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Consulting	38.2%
Financial Services	30.3%
Technology	16.3%
Own business	2.6%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey, Bain, Amazon, BCG, JP Morgan, Google, Pwc Strategy&, Accenture, Credit Suisse, Goldman Sachs, Bank of America Corporation, Citigroup, Microsoft, Morgan Stanley, Ernst & Young, PIMCO, Kearney, Facebook, William Blair

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$150,000

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 92.8%

**Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR CHICAGO BOOTH APPLICATION

BY JULIE FERGUSON

Julie spent five years at the University of Chicago Booth School of Business, having begun her career in higher education with the Lauder Institute at Wharton. At Chicago Booth, Julie worked as a Senior Associate Director of Admissions. In this role she coordinated admissions and recruiting events across the country, connecting prospective students with current students and alumni; interviewed applicants; and advised the admissions committee.



The academic culture at Chicago Booth encourages innovative thinking, challenging the status quo, and working together to achieve results.

1

WHEN SHOULD YOU APPLY?

Be strategic about which application deadline you will be pursuing. There are three application rounds (September, January, and April) at Chicago Booth, and, as with many other schools, earlier is not necessarily better. The Booth Admissions Committee knows that it will see great profiles in the first and second round, so the school does not need to fill all the places for consultants, bankers and software engineers in round 1, but will use the wait list with discretion to be able to consider everybody applying in round 2. So you are better off waiting for the 2nd round if that means you will have a more complete, well thought out application, or are able to complete a particularly impressive project, secure a promotion, or provide more examples for your recommender to use. The reality is that there are very few places left by round 3, but even then, the Admissions Committee recognizes that there will be a handful of strong candidates applying in the final round for whom places will be available. But the numbers game works against you at this stage, so plan ahead and shoot for September or January to maximize your chances.

HIGHLIGHT YOUR INDIVIDUALITY

2

Every year, hundreds of applications pour in from people with consulting, finance, and accounting backgrounds. Current full-time class statistics show that most students enter the program from a business, economics, and engineering undergraduate background. Chicago Booth looks to create a well- rounded, diverse, and unique class. Make this work in your favor, whether your background is “typical” or not. If you do come from a classic background, tailor your application to highlight what makes you different from everyone else in your industry (perhaps you work as an accountant for a non-profit organization). If, for example, you have a marketing/advertising, education, or social sciences background this will play well into creating a more diverse academic environment for the whole; you will want to emphasize the fact that you will be bringing something unique to the discussion, in and out of the classroom.

3

IT'S NOT ALL ABOUT "ECONOMICS"

There is a common perception that Chicago Booth is the "econ" school. Just like you, Booth does not want to be seen as being good at just one thing. The full-time MBA program provides a flexible curriculum, where students are expected to design their own academic experience. Even if your concentration (your academic interests) lies in economics and the world of finance, you should be well versed on what other academic concentrations are available. Know who the key professors are in each academic department and some of the key published academic research. Familiarize yourself with opportunities outside of your particular interests (such as the New Venture Challenge). The Booth MBA is a transformative experience; through your application, demonstrate to the admissions team that you have a plan, but that you are open to the possibilities and avenues that a Chicago MBA will provide. Show the Committee that you recognize the importance of a well-rounded MBA education, and that you appreciate the value of the flexible curriculum structure.

THE INTERVIEW

4

Chicago Booth extensively uses its network of staff, current students, and alumni to conduct admissions interviews throughout the year, all over the world. Although the interview receives equal weight in the overall application, regardless of who is conducting the interview, you should tailor your interview strategy accordingly. Typically, alumni and current students have a very different perception of how a candidate might fit in at Chicago Booth (using their own personal experience and background), and can often be much more critical evaluators than admissions staff. Admissions staff on the other hand will have a better sense for how the class is already shaping up, and how your unique experience could contribute to the current intake.

Use the interview to highlight areas of your personal and professional life that are not already represented in your application.

Be especially careful of "walking" your interviewer through your resume. They have already looked at your resume, and are looking to glean much more information from you than your professional history timeline. The purpose of the interview is to establish a connection with the person across the table, and convince them of why you are a good "fit" with Chicago Booth.

5

GET TO KNOW BOOTH AND DEFINE HOW YOU WILL BE ABLE TO CONTRIBUTE

The written application is the final piece of the puzzle. There are so many steps that lead up to that “submit” button. Admissions want to know that you are going to be more than a body in a lecture room. Part of what makes Chicago Booth such a thriving academic environment is the diversity of students in each of the MBA programs. This diversity is what drives critical thinking and pushes students into collaboration instead of competition. They want people who will get up and get involved, lead the charge. And beyond the classroom they are looking for engagement and interaction. So do some research on the clubs and activities that would be of interest to you, and where possible reach out to students or alumni who themselves were actively part of a particular club to better understand the opportunities available to you. When possible, you should try to visit campus and/or attend admissions events. It is important to see the programs in action and to see interaction between current students, faculty, and staff. Use all of the information at hand to truly comprehend your “fit” at Chicago Booth and show Admissions not only who you are but what you will contribute to the community as a current student and an alumnus.

For more insider insights into Chicago Booth please visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
Round 1	23 September 2021	02 December 2021
Round 2	06 January 2022	24 March 2022
Round 3	07 April 2022	26 May 2022
Chicago Booth Scholars	07 April 2022	09 June 2022



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

